

GENERAL SOCIAL SCIENCES

OVERVIEW

The social sciences examine human behaviour, including its causes and consequences, at the individual, societal, cultural, and global levels. The three courses in the general social sciences focus on theories and research from the fields of anthropology, psychology, and sociology with the goal of developing students' understanding of people as individuals and groups and of social institutions.

These courses provide the opportunity for students to explore human behaviour, social groups, institutions, and various societies by examining various contemporary issues. In these courses, students develop their awareness of and ability to use social science methodologies and perspectives to examine the causes of and responses to challenges such as technological change and global inequalities.

Introduction to Anthropology, Psychology, and Sociology, Grade 11

College Preparation

HSP3C

This course introduces students to theories, questions, and issues related to anthropology, psychology, and sociology. Students learn about approaches and research methods used by social scientists. Students will be given opportunities to apply theories from a variety of perspectives, to conduct social science research, and to become familiar with current issues within the three disciplines.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to anthropology, psychology, and sociology, and formulate questions appropriate for each discipline to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to anthropology, psychology, and sociology (*e.g., addictions, gender socialization, rites of passage*) to identify topics for research and inquiry

- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics

Teacher prompt: “A team of social scientists is studying the causes and effects of homelessness. In this research, which key concepts would be most important to the anthropologist, the psychologist, and the sociologist?”

- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry

Teacher prompt: “How could you use a survey or participant observation study to assess the extent of racism, sexism, or classism in your school?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., if conducting primary research, outline purpose and method; identify sources of information*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

Teacher prompts: “What steps can you take to ensure that you are not asking leading questions in your survey?” “For which purposes might websites such as Wikipedia be adequate sources of information? What are the risks of relying on websites such as Wikipedia?” “What is informed consent, and why is it important in social science research?”

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., interviews, observations, surveys, questionnaires, original documents in print or other media – film, photographs*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, research reports, newspaper and magazine articles*)

Teacher prompts: “What is the difference between primary and secondary sources in social science? How can you determine whether a source is a primary or secondary source?” “What criteria would you use to choose the best secondary sources related to your research question?”

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

A3.1 assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)

Teacher prompts: “What criteria can you use to determine potential biases of an author?”
“How can you assess sources for reliability?”

A3.2 record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., compare information gathered from primary and secondary sources; determine whether similar information is found in different sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answers to their research questions*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., oral presentation, brochure, flyer, poster, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to anthropology, psychology, and sociology correctly (*e.g., functionalism, structuralism, feminism, culture, socialization, ethnography, survey, archaeology, temperament, behaviour*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., generate a reference list in APA style*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompts: “How did the primary and/or secondary sources you used confirm what you already knew and understood about the topic? How did your sources contradict what you thought was true?” “Some people say that social science is based on common sense. In what ways did your research and/or inquiry show the value of research in social science?” “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. ANTHROPOLOGY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Theories, Perspectives, and Methodologies:** demonstrate an understanding of major theories, perspectives, and research methods in anthropology;
- B2. Explaining Human Behaviour and Culture:** use an anthropological perspective to explain how diverse factors influence and shape human behaviour and culture;
- B3. Socialization:** use a cultural anthropology perspective to explain patterns of human socialization.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Theories, Perspectives, and Methodologies

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** identify significant contributions of influential anthropologists (*e.g., Noam Chomsky, Charles Darwin, Jane Goodall, the Leakeys, Margaret Mead, Edward Sapir, Marvin Harris, Richard Lee, Biruté Galdikas, Sherry Ortner*)

- B1.2** outline the key ideas of major anthropological schools of thought (*e.g., functionalism, structuralism, cultural materialism, feminist anthropology*), and explain how they can be used to understand features of cultural systems

Teacher prompts: “What are some important differences between a functionalist and a structuralist approach to studying culture?” “How would a cultural materialist explain differences between urban, suburban, and rural youth?”

- B1.3** describe significant issues in different areas of anthropology (*e.g., linguistic, physical, cultural, and forensic anthropology; primatology*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the big questions in primatology?” “What are the big questions in ethnology?” “Are there any cultural universals or universal taboos?” “How can observers from one culture avoid bias in studying another culture?” “How do social media affect culture?”

- B1.4** describe the main research methods used for conducting anthropological research (*e.g., participant observation, oral history, semi-structured interview, ethnography, genealogy, archaeological excavation, decolonizing research methods*), and explain critiques of the various methods

Teacher prompts: “What are the skills and attitudes required for participant observation?” “What is an artefact, and why are artefacts so important in anthropological research?” “What key concerns do critics of anthropological research express? According to critics, in what ways may anthropological research methods have contributed to racist beliefs about non-Western cultures?”

B2. Explaining Human Behaviour and Culture

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** describe, from an anthropological perspective, how various factors (*e.g., physical environment, globalization, pandemics*) influence and shape human behaviour and culture (*e.g., technology, language, social structures, law, politics, religion and ritual, art*)

Teacher prompts: “In what ways does the threat of a pandemic influence human behaviour?” “How has environmental consciousness changed behaviour and culture?”

- B2.2** identify the effects that diffusion, assimilation, and multiculturalism have on culture

Teacher prompt: “What do you know about how the residential school system affected First Nation, Inuit, and Métis cultures and languages?”

- B2.3** explain how studying cultural systems of different times and places helps anthropologists understand human behaviour and culture in the present

Teacher prompt: “How does the study of marriage customs in the past help us understand male and female roles in modern societies?”

B3. Socialization

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 explain how culture produces diverse forms of human behaviour (*e.g., explain variations in rites of passage, language, family roles, the development of subcultures, or political practices from one culture to another*)

Teacher prompts: “How are the rites of passage for adolescents and young adults the same and different in three different cultures?”

What characteristics of these cultures might explain the different practices?”
“What subcultures exist in your school and community? How do these different subcultures affect people’s behaviour?”

B3.2 describe ways in which culture is an agent of socialization (*e.g., in communicating and upholding such things as kinship rights and obligations, social customs, religious practices*)

Teacher prompts: “How do children learn about the religious practices, customs, and beliefs of their communities? In what ways can this process be called ‘socialization’?”
“How are cultural norms passed along from generation to generation?”

C. PSYCHOLOGY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Theories, Perspectives, and Methodologies:** demonstrate an understanding of major theories, perspectives, and research methods in psychology;
- C2. Human Mental Processes and Behaviour:** use a psychological perspective to describe how diverse factors influence and shape human mental processes and behaviour;
- C3. Socialization:** use a psychological perspective to explain patterns of socialization.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Theories, Perspectives, and Methodologies

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify significant contributions of influential psychologists (*e.g., Erik Erikson, Sigmund Freud, Carl Jung, Abraham Maslow, Ivan Pavlov, Carl Rogers, B. F. Skinner, Thomas Bouchard, Mary Ainsworth, Carol Gilligan*)
- C1.2** outline the key ideas of major psychological theories (*e.g., psychodynamic theory, behaviourism, cognitive theory, humanistic theory*), and explain how they can be used to understand human behaviour
Teacher prompts: “What are some important differences between the behaviourist and the psychodynamic theories of human behaviour?” “From a humanist perspective, how does self-esteem affect school performance?” “If you were a school principal, how might Skinner’s theory of operant conditioning help you devise a strategy to decrease the number of students skipping class?”
- C1.3** compare significant psychological approaches to the study of human behaviour (*e.g., clinical, experimental, personality, abnormal, and developmental psychology*)
Teacher prompt: “What are the main differences between clinical and experimental psychology? How does each influence the other?”
- C1.4** describe the main research methods used for conducting psychological research (*e.g., experiments, surveys, observations*), and explain critiques of the various methods

Teacher prompts: “What is an experiment, and how is it different from a survey or a questionnaire?” “The possibility and the desirability of objectivity in psychological research have been questioned. For what reasons?”

C2. Human Mental Processes and Behaviour

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** describe, from a psychological perspective, how various factors (*e.g., heredity, environment, personality, identity, developmental stage, level of attachment*) influence and shape an individual’s psychological development
Teacher prompt: “How do relationships with peers affect an individual’s sense of self? To what extent does the impact depend on the individual’s developmental stage?”
- C2.2** describe, from a psychological perspective, ways in which context and the influence of other individuals can affect people’s emotional and behavioural responses (*e.g., at work, within a family, in sports groups/clubs, in crowds, in urban versus rural areas, among bystanders*)
Teacher prompt: “What are some psychological explanations for mob behaviour? In what ways does psychology fail to provide an adequate explanation?”
- C2.3** describe how diverse psychological factors (*e.g., motivation, perception, attitudes, mental health, temperament*) influence individual behaviour
Teacher prompt: “How do different temperaments influence people’s response to aggression?”

C3. Socialization

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** identify the role of socialization in the psychological development of the individual (*e.g., effects of direct teaching of social skills, effects of social isolation*)

Teacher prompts: “How does social acceptance affect an individual’s psychological development?” “How does social isolation affect emotional, social, intellectual, and linguistic development?”

- C3.2** describe how diverse personality traits (*e.g., introversion, openness to experience, perfectionism*) shape human behaviour and interaction in a variety of environments

Teacher prompt: “How might an extrovert and an introvert differ in the way they deal with stress?”

- C3.3** describe the procedures of and ethical problems associated with major psychological experiments in socialization (*e.g., Zimbardo’s Stanford prison experiment, Asch’s conformity experiment, Milgram’s obedience-to-authority experiment, Elliot’s “Blue-Eyed/Brown-Eyed” experiment*)

Teacher prompts: “What are the components of an ethical experiment?” “In what ways were Zimbardo’s, Asch’s, Milgram’s, and Elliot’s experiments unethical? How could these experiments be modified to be more ethical?”

D. SOCIOLOGY

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Theories, Perspectives, and Methodologies:** demonstrate an understanding of major theories, perspectives, and research methods in sociology;
- D2. Explaining Social Behaviour:** use a sociological perspective to explain how diverse factors influence and shape social behaviour;
- D3. Socialization:** use a sociological perspective to explain patterns of socialization.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Theories, Perspectives, and Methodologies

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify the significant contributions of influential sociologists (*e.g., Emile Durkheim, Karl Marx, Edward Said, Max Weber, Dorothy Smith, Charles Wright-Mills, Gordon Allport, Reginald Bibby, George Dei, Ibn Khaldun*)
- D1.2** outline the key ideas of the major sociological schools of thought (*e.g., structural functionalism, symbolic interactionism, conflict theory, feminist perspective*), and explain how they can be used to understand social behaviour
Teacher prompts: “From a feminist perspective, why is there inequality in the workplace?” “Why is it important to consider social as well as individual factors when trying to understand issues such as poverty or unemployment?”
- D1.3** identify and describe the main research methods that are used for conducting sociological research (*e.g., surveys, case studies, observations, secondary analysis of statistical results, content analysis, focus groups*), and describe critiques of the various methods
Teacher prompt: “What method or methods would you use to determine the relationship between the academic performance of Grade 11 students and the amount of time spent in employment or playing sports? What would be the limitations of sociological research methods for addressing this research question?”

D2. Explaining Social Behaviour

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** describe, from a sociological perspective, how diverse factors (*e.g., social norms and expectations, social structures, social sanctions, social distinctions, socio-economic status, geographic location, physical environment, media coverage*) influence and shape individual and group behaviour (*e.g., conformity, obedience, discrimination, “groupthink”, choice of occupation*)
Teacher prompts: “In what ways does socio-economic status affect people’s career choices?” “How are social norms and expectations, such as standing for the national anthem, communicated? What sanctions take place when a person does not stand for the playing of the national anthem?”
- D2.2** explain the relationship between prejudice and individual and systemic discrimination (*e.g., on the basis of gender, race, socio-economic status, sexual orientation, ability, religion, age, appearance*), and describe their impacts on individuals and society
Teacher prompts: “What is the impact of heterosexism on individuals and society?” “How are stereotypes conveyed in the media, and how do these stereotypes affect individual behaviour?”
- D2.3** describe, from a sociological perspective, ways in which diverse influences (*e.g., culture, religion, economics, technology*) shape social behaviour (*e.g., dating and courtship, social networking, bullying, following trends and fads*)

Teacher prompts: “How might culture influence dating and courtship practices?” “How do fads affect your behaviour?”

D3. Socialization

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 describe how structural changes take place in social institutions (*e.g., family; religious institutions; legal, political, educational, and health systems; the military*) in response to diverse influences (*e.g., demographic or economic change, the growth of environmentalism, the introduction of the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms, social movements*)

Teacher prompts: “How have environmental initiatives affected your school and local institutions?” “How has awareness of restorative justice practices influenced the Canadian justice system?” “To what extent have the events of September 11, 2001, changed our social institutions?” “How has immigration changed social institutions in Canada?”

D3.2 describe ways in which social structures (*e.g., economy, family, class, gender, race*) affect individual and group behaviour

Teacher prompts: “How might an economic downturn affect some people’s decisions to go to college or university?” “How does socio-economic status affect the job possibilities that people perceive for themselves?” “What is racial profiling, and what is the impact of racial profiling on individuals and groups?” “How can social structures work to convince individuals to behave in a more environmentally responsible manner?”

D3.3 compare the relative influence of primary agents of socialization (*e.g., family, peers*) and secondary agents of socialization (*e.g., media, religion*) on the socialization of the individual

Teacher prompt: “What are some ways in which diverse agents of socialization affect people’s life decisions? Which have the most influence on you and your peers? On your family? On public figures?”